

Redevelopment Commission Meeting August 14th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9jk4XjHimRs
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Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 14, 2025

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Amber Green called the August 14, 2025 meeting of the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission to order at [00:00:47](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Keysling, Ms. Green (Presiding Officer), Commissioner Brand, Commissioner Henry, and Mr. Wiggley.
 - **Absent:** None noted.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:51](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the July 10th meeting were approved by voice vote ([00:01:34](#)).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:05 Table Business 4A: Yorktown Stormwater Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chase Brutin, Town Manager of Yorktown.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Brutin updated the commission on a stormwater project on the north side of Jackson Street (east of 600, near Kamak Station) designed to fix failing drainage and eliminate a mosquito swamp. The lowest bid came from Midwest Paving at \$140,969.69. Yorktown requested the commission fund half of the construction cost. Discussions addressed TIF fund selection to avoid draining funds needed for other potential park projects.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved \$70,484.84 (Yorktown to cover the extra penny) by roll call vote (Yes: Brand, Henry, Wiggley; No: Keysling, Green).
- **00:11:08 Table Business 4C: Fusion Road Bid Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Unidentified presenter.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission removed the item from the table. EMB Paving was identified as the lowest overall bidder at \$795,502.25. Staff noted that bids cannot be split between competing companies. Funding is to be pulled from Magna TIF and potentially Fountain Square.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved proceeding with EMB Paving by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:13:34 Table Business 4D: MC Trail Bid Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Unidentified presenter and Kenny from VS Engineering.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Removed from the table. Yarberry was the lowest respondent at \$74,270 above estimate (~15-16% over). Discussion touched upon ongoing difficulties communicating with the railroad regarding crossing timelines. Funding to be split between Midwest and Progress Rail TIFs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved Yarberry's bid of \$74,270 by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:20:45 New Business: America's Hometown Band Funding Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. McConnell, representing America's Hometown Band.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. McConnell requested \$30,000 to support the band's annual budget (just under \$60,000) for municipal concerts and community outreach. Commissioners Henry and Brand raised concerns that the band predominantly performs within Muncie rather than the broader county, questioning the allocation of county tax funds without broader geographic reach.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table pending submission of detailed historical budgets (2024-2025) and a concrete plan for countywide engagement (such as performances in Selma, Albany, Gaston, etc.). Approved by roll call vote (Yes: Keysling, Green, Wiggley; No: Brand, Henry).
- **00:33:56 New Business: Muncie Senior Center Financial Assistance Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Julie Mers, Executive Director.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Ms. Mers requested \$5,394.12 to help cover unexpected emergency water and sewage leak repairs from March 2025 that strained the center's minimal budget. She highlighted that the center serves nearly 1,000 unique individuals monthly from across the county and that a failing flat roof (\$23,000 estimate) represents an even more pressing capital need. Commissioners expressed strong support given the center's vital role in combating senior isolation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved \$30,000 to cover immediate repairs (water leak and roof replacement) to be drawn from the Magna TIF fund, passed by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:43:39 New Business: 12-Acre Site Subdivision Proposal (Muncie)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. How.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a proposal for a 42-home premium subdivision (starting around \$425,000) on 12 acres previously given to the Muncie Redevelopment Commission that has generated no property taxes for 16 years. Total infrastructure/lot development costs are estimated at \$2.1 million. The developer/city/sanitary district requests partner backing, asking the DCRC for \$10,000 per lot (\$420,000 total). Commissioners noted a lack of detailed engineering maps and existing neighborhood requests to vacate access roads.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled for further detailed information and maps by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **00:43:57 New Business: 8.33-Acre Site at I-69 and State Road 67 (Daleville)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Unidentified presenter / Bill Walders (representing Daleville).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed active inquiries from two Delaware County-based companies interested in purchasing and developing the 8.33-acre site adjacent to the Daleville shell building. Discussion focused on historic land costs (\$166,000 in 2012), lack of direct ingress/egress easements (currently dependent on a service road/gas station path), and the need for a professional value opinion/appraisal rather than full commercial appraisals.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to secure a professional opinion of value (local valuation) and investigate access options with Mr. Reed, approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **01:05:16 New Business: Bitechnic Electrical Upgrade Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Michelle Batters, ECI Regional Planning District.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested \$27,320 for electrical upgrades to support a fourth manufacturing line for Bitechnic USA Inc. (which supplies Toyota and leases a facility on South Hoy). Previous benchmarks were paid out of the CREED account.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to refer the request to the CREED board, approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **01:08:22 New Business: Living Greens Farm Loan Consent Documents**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sarah Carell, Ice Miller (Bond Counsel).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Counsel presented loan consent documents for Living Greens Farm. Originally issued in 2022, a new developer has purchased the bonds but requires a private construction loan. The lender requests that the TIF be formally recognized as collateral under the existing authorized financing agreements. Legal counsel and local staff confirmed this creates no new financial liability or obligations for the county.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved request/consent documents by roll call vote (Yes: Keysling, Green, Brand, Henry; No: Wiggley).
- **01:17:03 New Business: Gaston Sidewalk Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand and Jeff Larrison (United Consulting).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a project requested during town hall meetings to build a sidewalk extending north from Gaston along Sycamore Street to connect residents safely to the Dollar Store. Preliminary estimates total \$264,300 (including engineering, land acquisition, construction, and inspection). Potential cost reductions include seeking right-of-way donations from Dollar Tree.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved entering into a professional services agreement with United Consulting to move the project forward by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **01:21:00 Informational Items & Reports**
 - **Metro Power Products Update:** Kathy White, CFO, provided an annual report on the Park One facility expansion (adding ~90,000 sq. ft., shifting tank manufacturing from Fairmont, and targeting mid-next year completion with 80+ new employees). Total investment through 2024 is approximately \$12.5 million.
 - **Morrison Road TIF Receipt:** Noted a receipt of \$15,993.49 resulting from a state audit on a 2014 project, deposited back into the Morrison TIF.
- **01:26:51 Invoices & Claims Approval**
 - **Standard Invoices:** Approved general invoices totaling \$21,433.85 by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously). Note: Included approval authorizing President Green to sign a certificate of substantial completion for the Daleville project [01:34:52](#).
 - **Bond & TIF Invoices:** Approved bond-related invoices and claims totaling \$854,210.66 (adjusting for duplicate Living Greens Farm line items) by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:31:53 Rick Yenser:** Addressed the commission regarding Indiana's power grid demands, utility capacities, and expressed skepticism regarding government spending on housing subdivisions versus core infrastructure and job creation.
- **01:36:18 Kathy Greywee:** Raised formal concerns regarding a potential Open Door Law violation during the July meeting, alleging that a quorum of commissioners (Henry, Brand,

Green) and legal counsel met in an adjacent room during a recess. (Commission members and attorney responded that no meeting occurred and that they were simply waiting on financial documents from the auditor's office).

- **01:39:30 Ed Carroll (County Auditor):** Reported on a productive meeting held between his office, Amber Green, Gina, Tracy, Steve Brand, and legal counsel Danielle to streamline procedures, communication, and bond payment processes going forward.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** The next regular meeting is scheduled for **September 11th, 2025, at 9:00 a.m.** at the same location.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second (**01:42:18**).

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